



### Twitter CEO called out for trolling

Twitter CEO Jack Dorsey got called out for trolling during the US Congress misinformation hearing. <http://digit.in/apr21-05>



### AI backpack for the blind

Indian developer Jagdish Mahendran has developed an AI backpack that can help blind people. <http://digit.in/apr21-06>



## PART II

A number of startups associated with the Naropa Fellowship are addressing issues in an ecologically and culturally sensitive way

Aditya Madanapalle | [aditya@digit.in](mailto:aditya@digit.in)

**I**n January this year we covered a cluster of startups that sprung up around Hemis in Ladakh, associated with the Naropa Fellowship, a leadership program with modern courses for the local youth in the Himalayas. The idea of the fellowship is to provide the skills to the entrepreneurial youth, to implement the latest

technologies in new business ventures. The result is a number of startups that are environmentally conscious, integrate with the local traditions and customs, and promote local production, or address more global problems while providing employment to the locals. We also take a look at some more interesting startups associated with the Naropa Fellowship.

### SERZANG REMOVES INTERMEDIARIES IN THE PASHMINA TRADE

Serzang is a startup working in the Changthang valley of Ladakh, its Pashmina producing region, to make sure that the nomads who produce the Pashmina wool get the fair price for their commodity. Serzang employs the local youth from the valley to produce authentic, handwoven, pure Pashmina products, providing them local employment. Kunang Dorjay, founder of Serzang told us how they integrate with the local producers, "We work with the main producers for weaving from the unemployed youth or women of the village. We work with the women of

the villagers in collaboration with Self Help groups." When asked what are the main problems the startup is facing, Dorjay told us that it is marketing and funding, "We are trying to figure out our marketing with the help of Digit and some social media influencers. For now we are facing funding problems as here in Ladakh we are unable to get investors." Digit's IndiaProject is an initiative to identify and promote hidden gems in India's startup ecosystem, giving them exposure on our website banner ads and social media feeds, apart from coverage of their activities.

### SKILLGRAM HELPS DISADVANTAGED YOUTH ACQUIRE ESSENTIAL PROFESSIONAL AND LIFE SKILLS

One of the problems in India is that the youth from disadvantaged backgrounds do not get the exposure or opportunities required to pick up essential professional skills that are sought after in the job market. Skillgram hopes to bridge this gap between what educational institutions teach the youth, and the demands of the industry,